AA-F-001873/1A(GSA-FSS)
August 23, 1977
SUPERSEDING
AA-F-001873/1(GSA-FSS)
November 20, 1973

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

FURNITURE, CONTEMPORARY OAK SEATING PIECES

(DETAILED SPECIFICATION)

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the National Furniture Center, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, Washington, DC 20406, based upon currently available technical information It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above This specification forms a part of the latest issue of Interim Federal Specification AA-F-001873/GEN

1 SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1 1 Scope This specification covers the detailed requirements for contemporary oak seating pieces General requirements and other information pertaining to these items, including the paragraphs listed in the cross reference table will be found in AA-F-001873/GEN(GSA-FSS), Furniture, Contemporary Oak (General Specification)

1 2 Classification The items shall be of the following types (see 6.1 herein).

Type I - Chair, lounge, low back, with arms, upholstered seat and back
Type II - Sofa, two seat, with arms, upholstered seat and back
Type III - Sofa, three seat, with arms, upholstered seat and back
Type IV - Ottoman, upholstered tight cushion
Type V - Chair, desk, without arms, upholstered seat
Type VI - Cushion, bench, upholstered, button tufted (for use with Cube Bench)

2 APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2 1 Specifications and standards The specifications and standards of the issue in effect on the date of the invitation for bids which form a part of the specification are listed in 2 1 of AA-F-001873/GEN, hereinafter called the General Specification.

2.2 Other publications The documents which form a part of this specification are listed in 2.2 of the General Specification

3 REQUIREMENTS

3 1 Preproduction sample Preproduction sample requirements shall be as given in 3 . of the General specification

3.2 Materials Materials used in construction of the seating pieces shall be of the kind and quality Specified in 3.2 of the General Specification and the applicable paragraph numbers of the latter for component materials used herein as given in table I

TABLE I. Materials cross-reference

Component	AA-F-001873/GEN Par No
Adhesives	3.2 1 - General Specification
Plywood and Laminated Parts	3 2.5 - General Specification
Edgebanding	3.2.6 - General Specification
Hardboard	3 2 7 - General Specification
Dowels	3.2.8 - General Specification
Tacks and Staples	3.2 9 - General Specification
Fastening devices	3 2.10 - General Specification
Glides	3.2.14 - General Specification
Polyurethane foam	3.2.15 - General Specification
Wood varieties and parts	3 2.16 - General Specification
Upholstery material	3 2.17 - General Specification

FSC 7105

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-26T11:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currentversion before use.

3.3 Construction. The general requirements for construction of the seating pieces shall be as specified in 3 3 of the General Specification and the applicable paragraph numbers of the latter for components used herein are given in Table II

TABLE II. Construction requirements cross-reference

Component	AA-F-001873/GEN Par. No.
Design	3.3.1 - General Specification
Assembly	3 3 2 - General Specification
Tolerances	3 3 3 - General Specification
Joinery	3 3 4 - General Specification
Edging	3 3 5 - General Specification
Finish	3 4 - General Specification
Workmanship	3.7 - General Specification

3 4 Type I, Chair, low back, with arms, upholstered seat and back Chair shall be constructed as described and illustrated in Figures 1, 3, 4, 6, 6A, 6B, 6C and 7 All parts and surfaces shall be finished as specified in paragraph 3 4 and sub-paragraphs of the General Specification

3 5 Type II, Sofa, two seat, with arms, upholstered seat and back Sofa shall be constructed as described and illustrated in Figures 2, 3, 4, 6, 6A, 6B, 6C and 7 All parts and surfaces shall be finished as specified in paragraph 3 4 and sub-paragraphs of the General Specification

3 6 Type III, Sofa, three seat, with arms, upholstered seat and back Sofa shall be constructed as described and illustrated in Figures 2, 3, 5, 6, 6A, 6B, 6C and 7 All parts and surfaces shall be finished as specified in paragraph 3 4 and sub-paragraphs of the General Specification

3 7 Type IV, Ottoman, upholstered tight cushion Ottoman shall be constructed as described and illustrated in Figures 8, 9 and 10 herein All parts and surfaces shall be finished as specified in paragraph 3 4 and sub-paragraphs of the General Specification

3 8 Cushions for lounge chair, sofa and ottoman

3.8 1 Seat cushion for Type I, II, III and IV units The seat cushion shall have a minimum of five 9 gage sinuous springs securely fastened to the front and back rails with insulated clips The springs shall be stabilized laterally with 2 pieces of 12-K Flex-Core-or-equal, 5/32 inch O D , kraft wrapped, 12 gage oil tempered wire The springs shall be covered with wire reinforced burlap and fastened to the springs on the frame The burlap shall be covered with 3 inches of polyurethane foam (3 2 15 of the General Specification) which shall consist of a 2 inch layer of Grade C with a 1 inch layer of Grade B wrap-around glued to it The two sides shall be bumper padded with 1/4 inch of Grade C foam The cover shall be cut to pattern and luggage (saddle) stitched with a tape backup The thread color shall match the upholstery material color The cover shall be secured with concealed stapling The underside of the seat cushion shall be covered with either cambric or polyethylene fabric (3 2 17 3 and 3 2 17 4 of the General Specification) The finished seat cushion dimensions for the Type I, II and III units shall be 24-3/4"W x 23"D x 7-1/2"H (6 inch side panels with a 1-1/2 to 1-1/2 inch crown) The finished seat cushion dimensions for the Type IV ottoman shall be 24-1/2"W x 20"D x 7-1/2"H (6 inch side panels with a 1-1/4 to 1-1/2 inch crown)

3 8 2 Back cushion for Type I, II and III units The back cushion shall have a minimum of four 12 gage sinuous springs fastened to the spring and top rails The springs shall be stabilized laterally with 2 pieces of 12-K Flex-Core or equal, 5/32 inch O D , kraft wrapped 12 gage oil tempered wire The springs shall be covered with wire reinforced burlap and fastened to the springs on the frame The burlap shall be covered with 2 inches of polyurethane foam (3 2 15 of the General Specification) which shall consist of 1 inch layer of Grade C with a 1 inch layer of Grade A top to bottom wrap-around glued to it The two sides and outside back shall be padded with 1/4 inch of Grade C foam The cover shall be cut to pattern and luggage (saddle) stitched with a tape back up The thread color shall match the upholstery material color The entire back cushion shall be covered and secured by concealed staples The finished back cushion dimensions shall be 25"W x 24-1/4"H x 9-1/2 inches thick at the bottom tapering to 6 inches thick at the top (8 inch side panels at the bottom to 4-1/2 inches at the top with a 1-1/4 to 1-1/2 inch crown).

3 9 Type V Chair, desk, without arms, upholstered seat Chair shall be constructed as described and illustrated in Figures 11 and 12. All parts and surfaces shall be finished as specified in paragraph 3 4 and sub-paragraphs of the General Specification

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-26T11:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currentversion before use.

3.9.1 Seat cushion for desk chair. The seat cushion shall have 1-1/2 inches thick Grade D polyurethane foam (3 2.15 of the General Specification.) glued securely to the seat pan The entire front edge shall have a strip 2 inches wide by 3/4 inch thick of the same grade glued to it The seat cover shall be cut to pattern, pulled tightly over the polyurethane and stapled to the underside of the seat pan The cover shall be trimmed and the entire underside shall be covered with either cambric or polyethylene fabric (3.2 17.3 and 3.2 17.4 of the General Specification). The finished seat cushion dimensions shall be 18-1/2 inches wide by 20-1/4 inches deep.

3 10 Type VI, cushion, bench, upholstered, buttom tufted The bench cushion shall consist of a polyurethane foam filler, box panels with self welts and eight buttons (four on the top, four on the bottom)

3 10 1 Filler The cushion fillers shall be 3 inches of Grade D polyurethane foam (3 2 15 of the General Specification)

3.10.2 Upholstery cover The upholstery cover (3 2.17 of the General Specification) shall have 2-1/2 inch box panels with self welts. The welts shall be straight and parallel The cushion shall have four 3/4 inch diameter buttons matching the color of the upholstery material The buttons shall be evenly spaced and the cord shall have a 50 pound breaking strength The finished cushion dimensions shall be 18 inches square by 3 inches thick.

3.11 Labels Each upholstered item shall be labeled as specified in 3.5 of the General Specification

3 12 Identification marking (see 3.6 of the General Specification)

3 13 Workmanship (see 3 7 of the General Specification)

4 QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4 1 The quality assurance provisions shall be as specified in Section 4 of the General Specification

5 PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5 1 Packaging Packaging shall be as specified in Section 5 1 of the General Specification (see 6 1 herein)

5.2 Packing Packing shall be as specified in Section 5 2 of the General Specificatior (see 6 1 herein)

5 3 Marking

5 3 1 Civil agencies In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, all marking shall be in accordance with FED-STD-123

5 3 2 Military activities In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, all marking shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-129

5 3 3 Special marking In addition to the markings required by 5 3 1 or 5 3 2 herein, the front and back panels of each shipping container shall be marked in each upper corner with the work "UP" and an arrow pointing to the direction in which the container should be placed for shipping and storage "UP" shall be in minimum 2 inch high characters In addition, the top panel of the container shall be marked with the following in minimum 2 inch high characters

TOP

THIS SIDE UP

FURNITURE

FRAGILE-HANDLE WITH CARE

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

The front side and back side of each shipping container shall be marked with the following in minimum 2 inch high characters:

FURNITURE

FRAGILE-HANDLE WITH CARE

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered in this specification and procurement documents should specify the following

(a) Number, title and date of this specification.

(b) Number, title and date of the General Specification.

(c) Type required (see 1.2 herein).

(d) Color of wood finish if other than English Oak (see 3.4 of the General Specification).

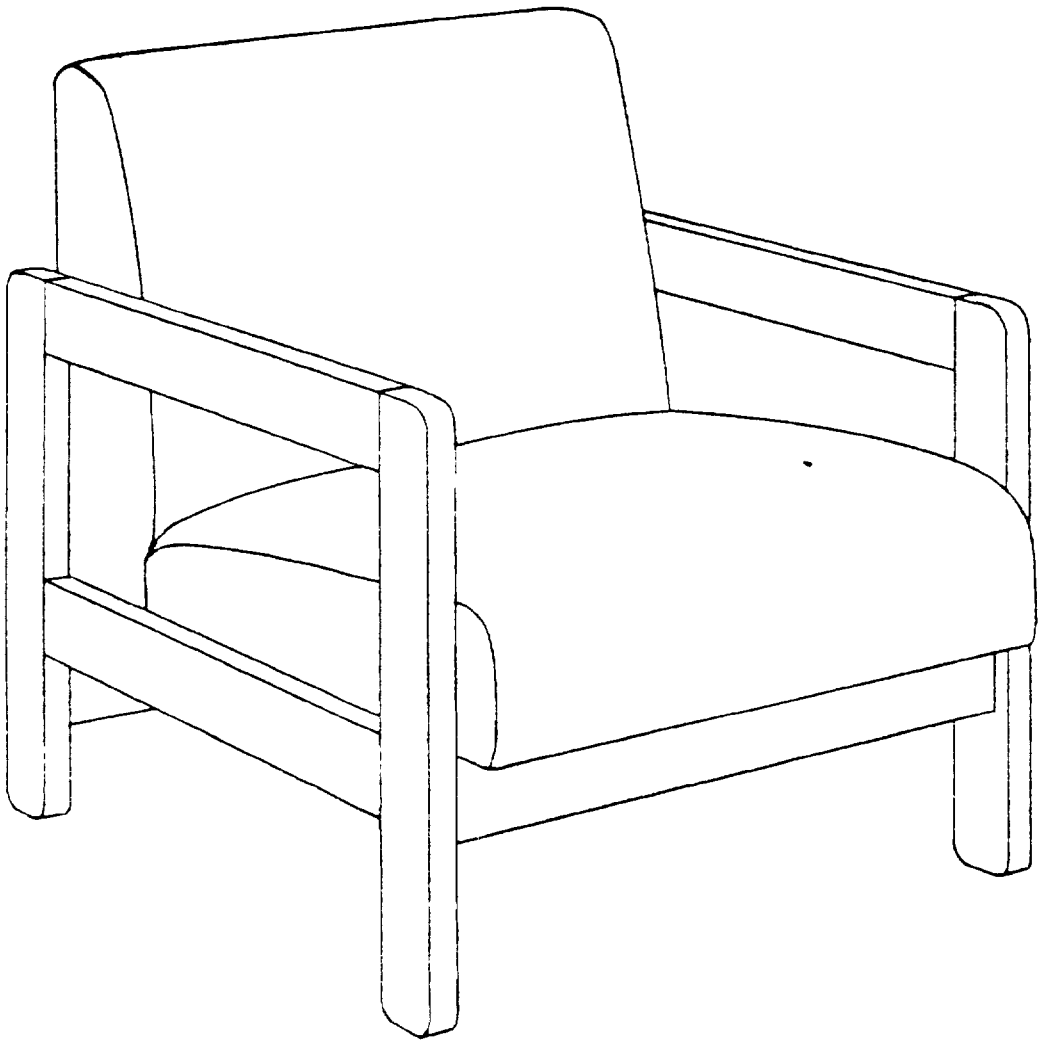
(e) Color and type of upholstery material (vinyl and fabric) required (see 3.2.17.11 and 3.2.17.2.1 of the General Specification).

(f) If preproduction sample is not required (see 3.1 herein)

(g) Level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2 of the General Specification)

GSA DC 78-432

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T11:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

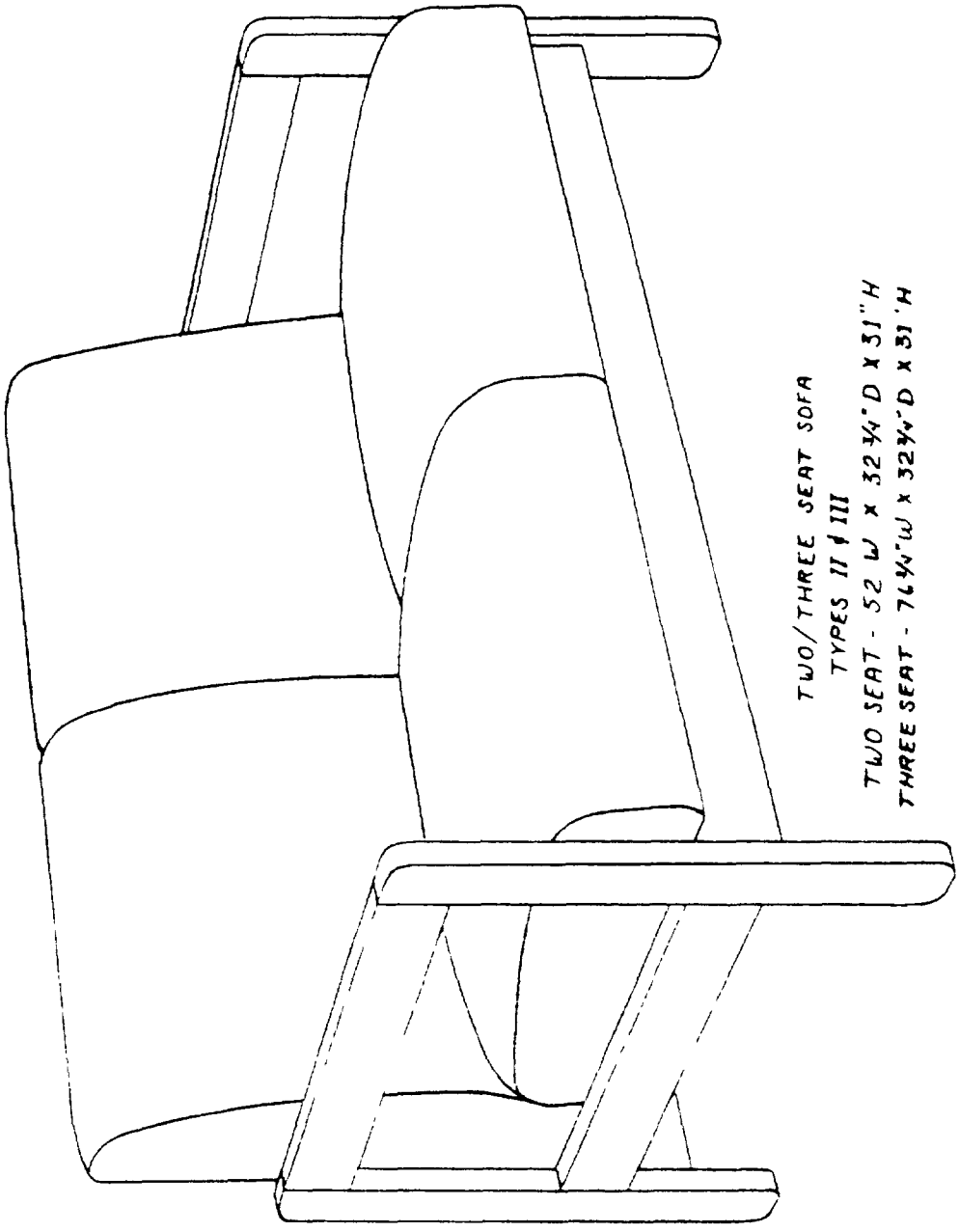


LOUNGE CHAIR
TYPE I
27¼"WIDE x 32¾"D x 31"H

FIGURE 1

NOT TO SCALE

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

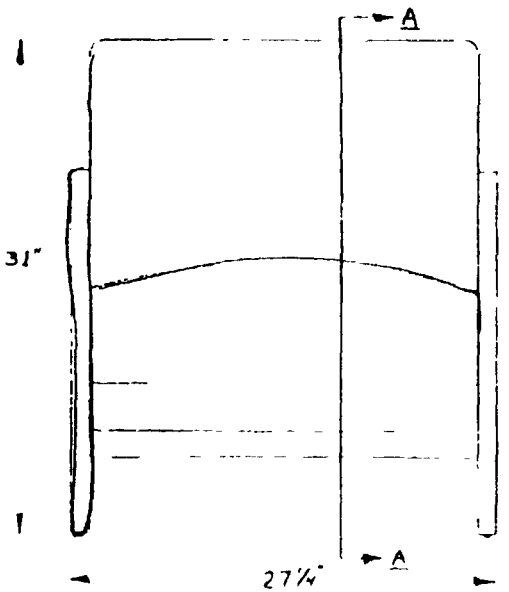


NOT TO SCALE

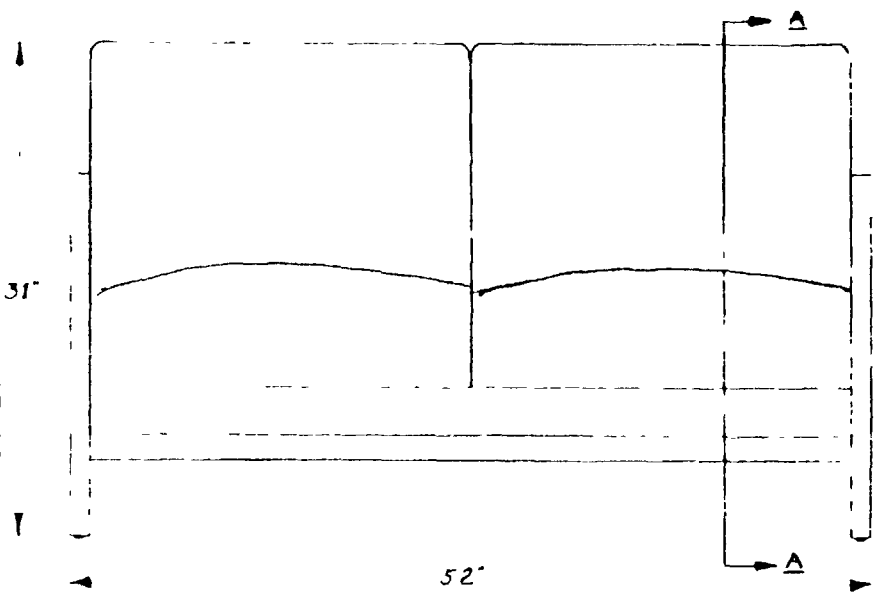
TWO/THREE SEAT SOFA
TYPES II & III
TWO SEAT - 52 W x 32 ¾" D x 31" H
THREE SEAT - 74 ¾" W x 32 ¾" D x 31" H

FIGURE 2

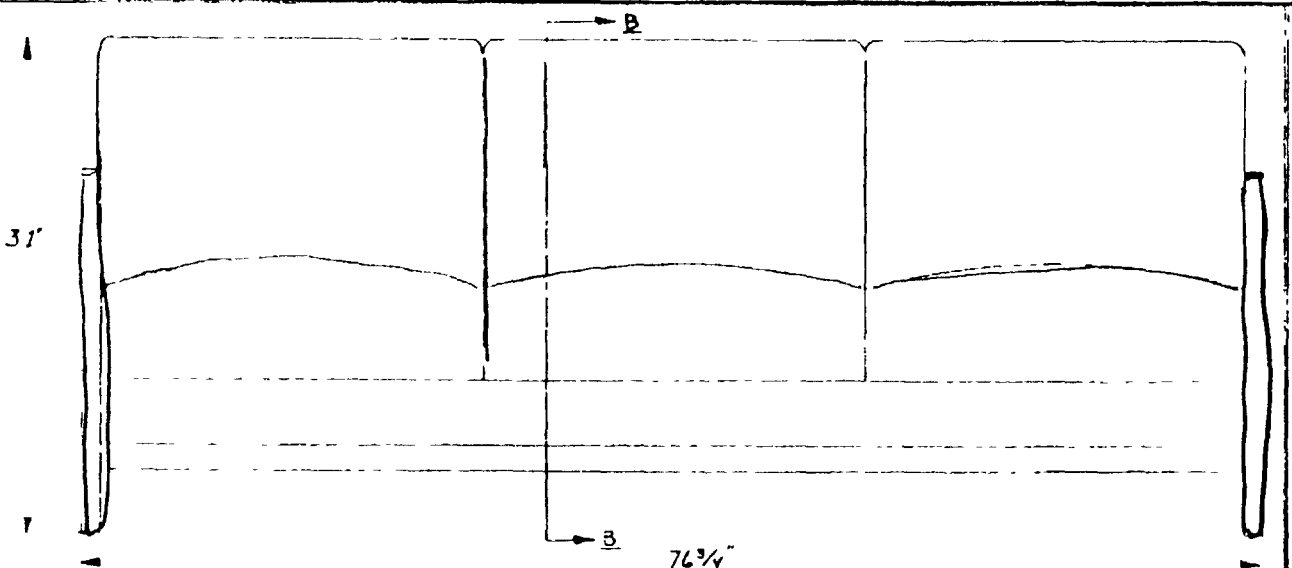
Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



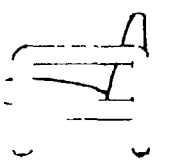
Front View - Type I Chair



Front View - Type II, Sofa Two Seat



Front View - Type III Sofa, Three Seat



Side View
Type I Chair
Type II Sofa
Type III Sofa

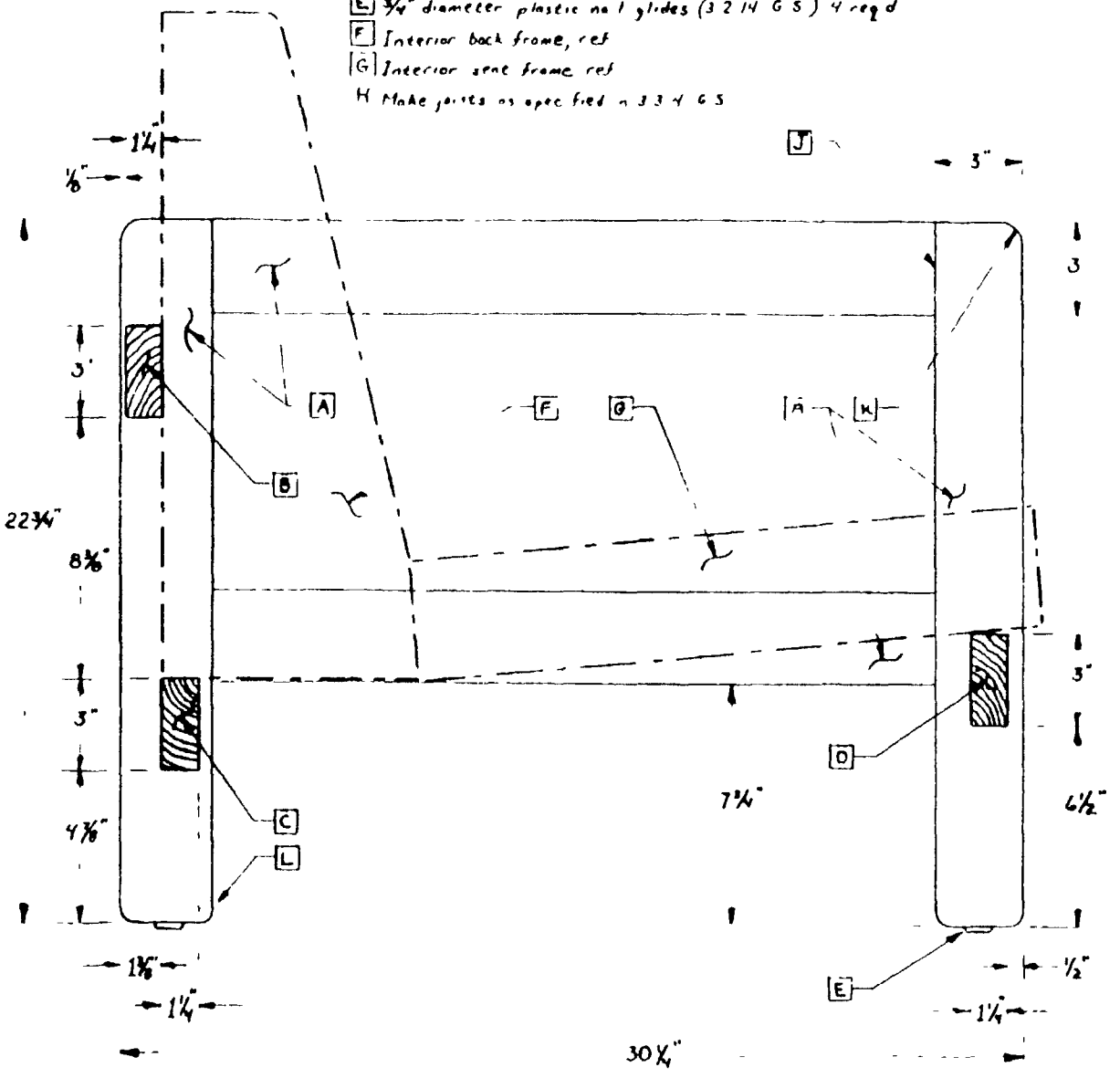
FIGURE 3

AA-F-001873/1A(GSA-FSS)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

NOTES

[A] "A" frame (exposed), make from solid wood (3 2 16-G S)
[B] Upper back rail (exposed), Make from solid wood (3 2 16-G S)
[C] Lower back rail (exposed); Make from solid wood (3 2 16 G S)
[D] Front rail (exposed), Make from solid wood (3 2 16-G S) and reinforce with glue screw blocks
[E] 3/4" diameter plastic nail glides (3 2 14 G S) 4 req'd
[F] Interior back frame, ref
[G] Interior seat frame ref
H Make joints as specified in 3 3 4 G S
[J] Make A frame joints flush both sides typ 16 plcs
[K] 1" radius typ 4 plcs (top corners of arms)
[L] 1/2 radius typ 8 plcs (bottom corners of legs)



NOT TO SCALE

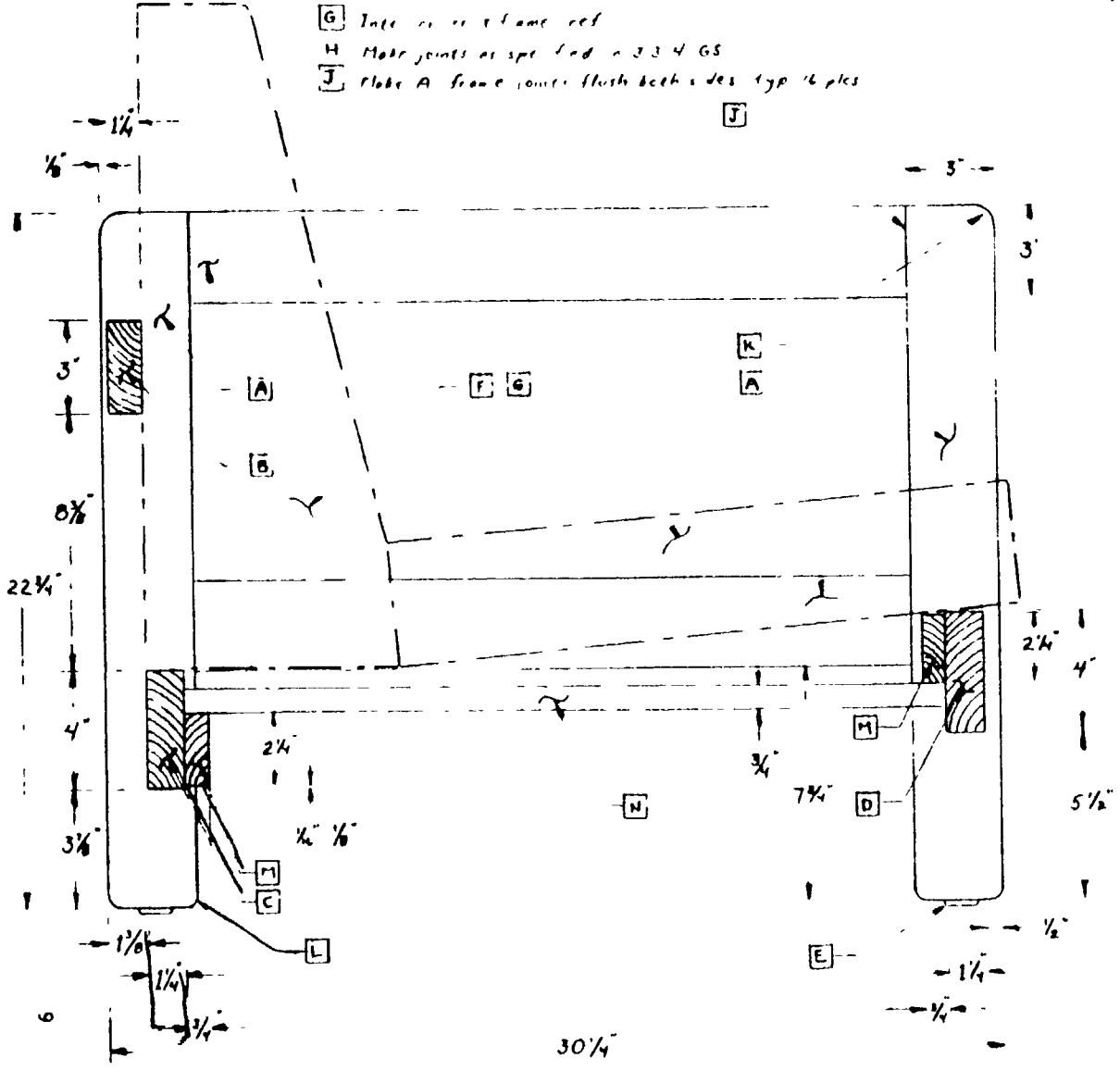
SECTION AA
Exterior frame for
TYPE I CHAIR
TYPE II SOFA
(interior seat and back frames removed)

FIGURE 4

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

NOTES

[A] A frame ref
[B] Upper back rail ref
[C] Lower back rail ref
[D] Front rail ref
[E] Glide ref
[F] Inside arm frame ref
[G] Inside seat frame ref
H Make joints as specified in 3.3.4 GS
[J] Plane A frame inner flush both sides typ 16 places
[K] 1 radius typ 4 places (typ at each end of arms)
[L] 1/2 radius typ 8 places (bottom of each leg)
[M] Reinforcement plates (as required) 2 1/4 x 1/4 minimum of 6" long centered and securely attached to rail typ 2 places
[N] Center support (as required) 2 1/4 x 1/4, securely attached to side rails and/or end rails



NOT TO SCALE

SECTION BB
Exercise frame for
TYPE III SOFA
(mechanism seat and back cushions removed)

FIGURE 5

AA-F-001823/1A(GSA-FSS)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-02-26T11:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

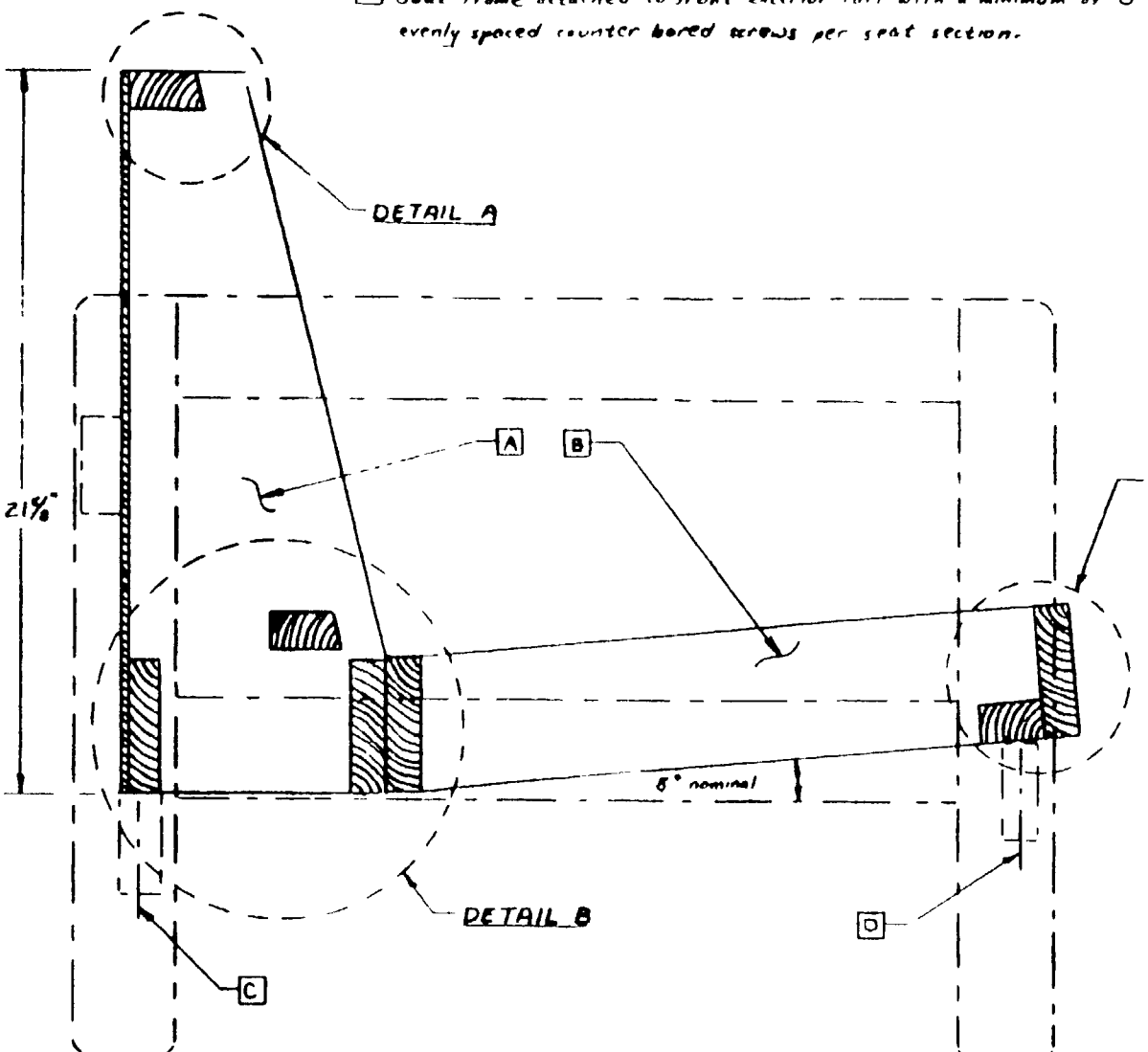
NOTES

A Interior back frame (see FIGURE 7)

B Interior seat frame (see FIGURE 7)

C Back frame attached to lower back, exterior rail with a min of 3 evenly spaced, counter bored screws per seat section.

D Seat frame attached to front exterior rail with a minimum of 3 evenly spaced counter bored screws per seat section.



NOT TO SCALE

SECTIONS AA and BB

Showing seat and back interior frames for:

TYPE I CHAIR

TYPE II SOFA

TYPE III SOFA

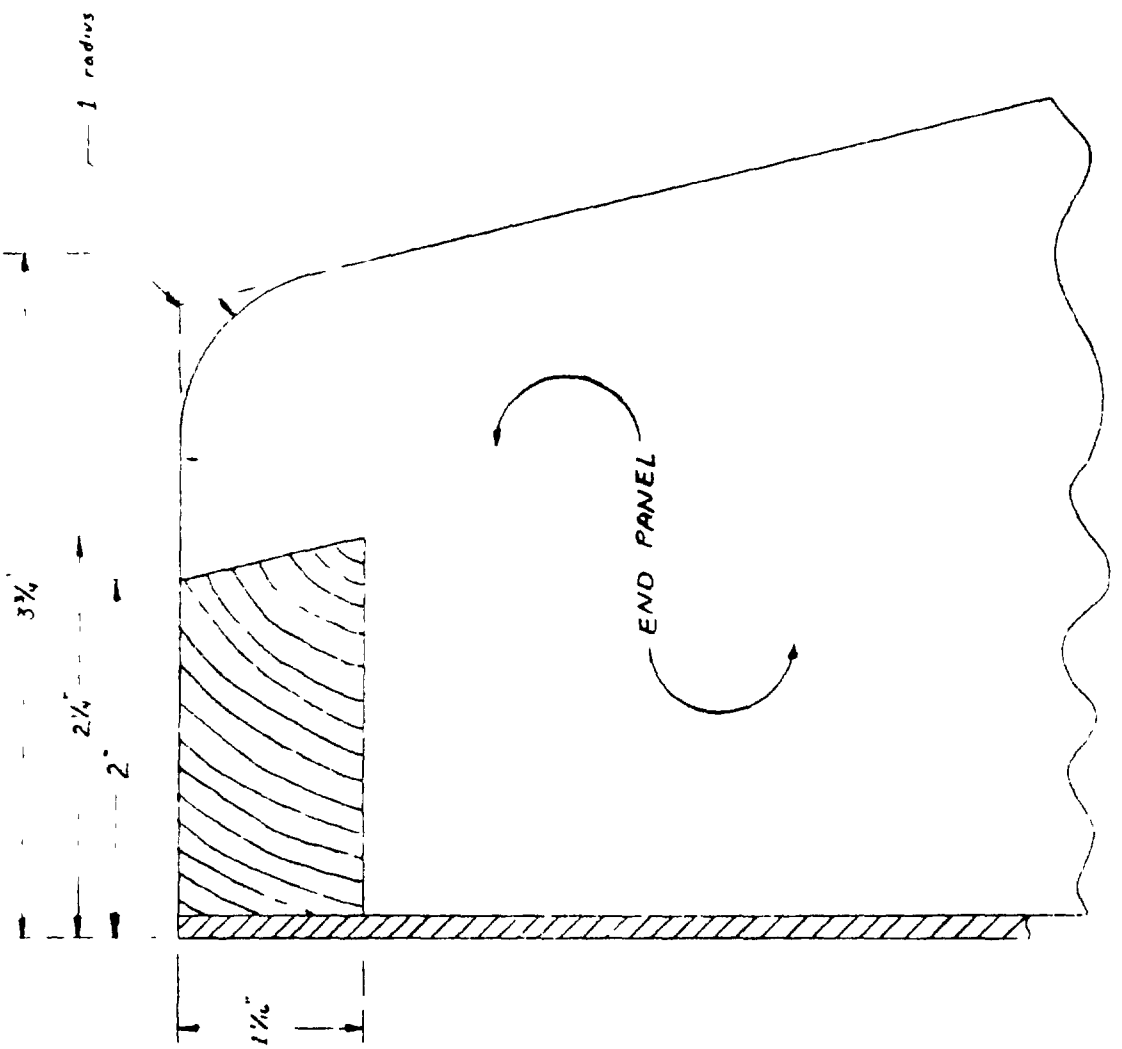
FIGURE 6

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

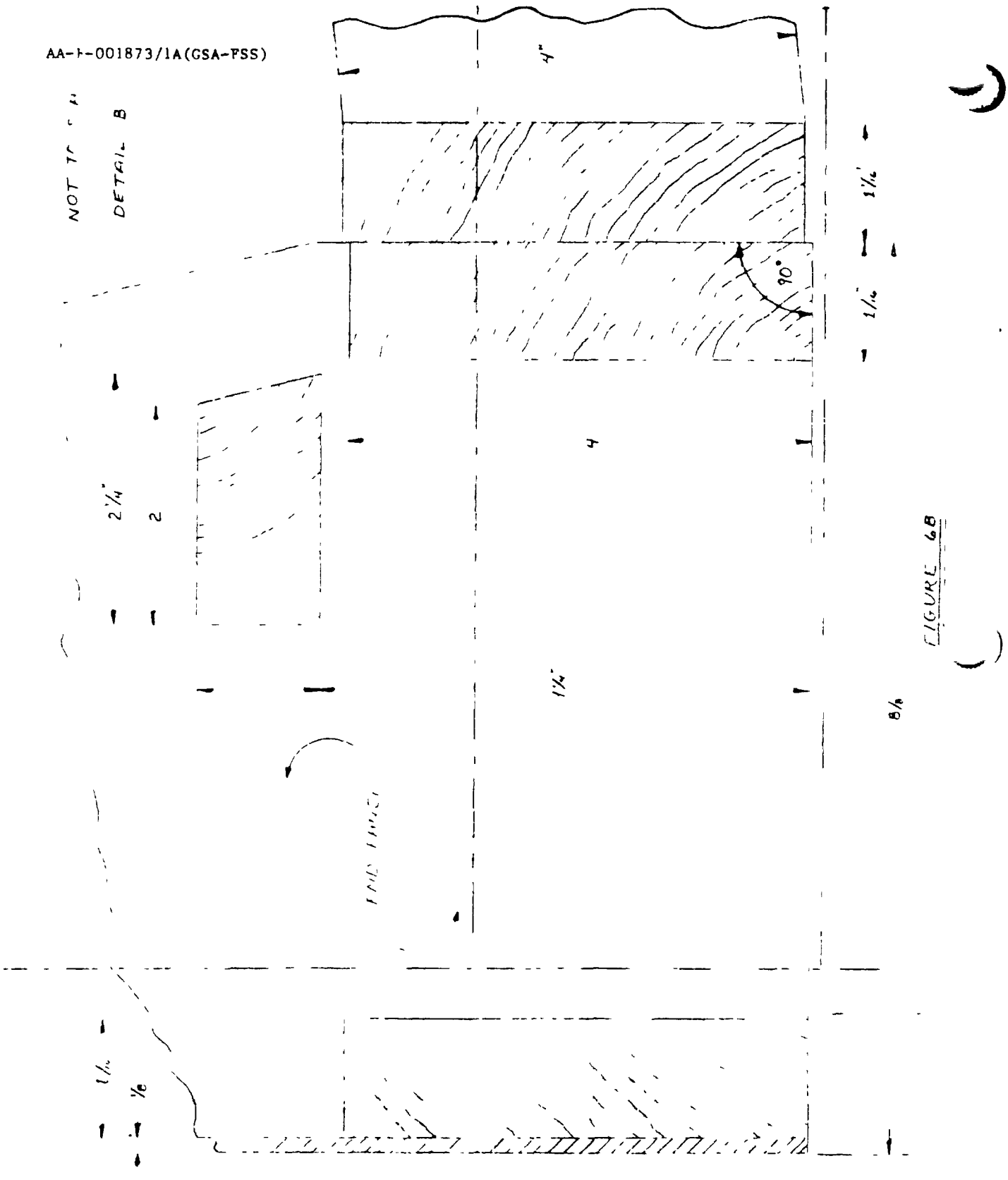
FIGURE 6A

DETAIL A

NOT TO SCALE



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T11:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

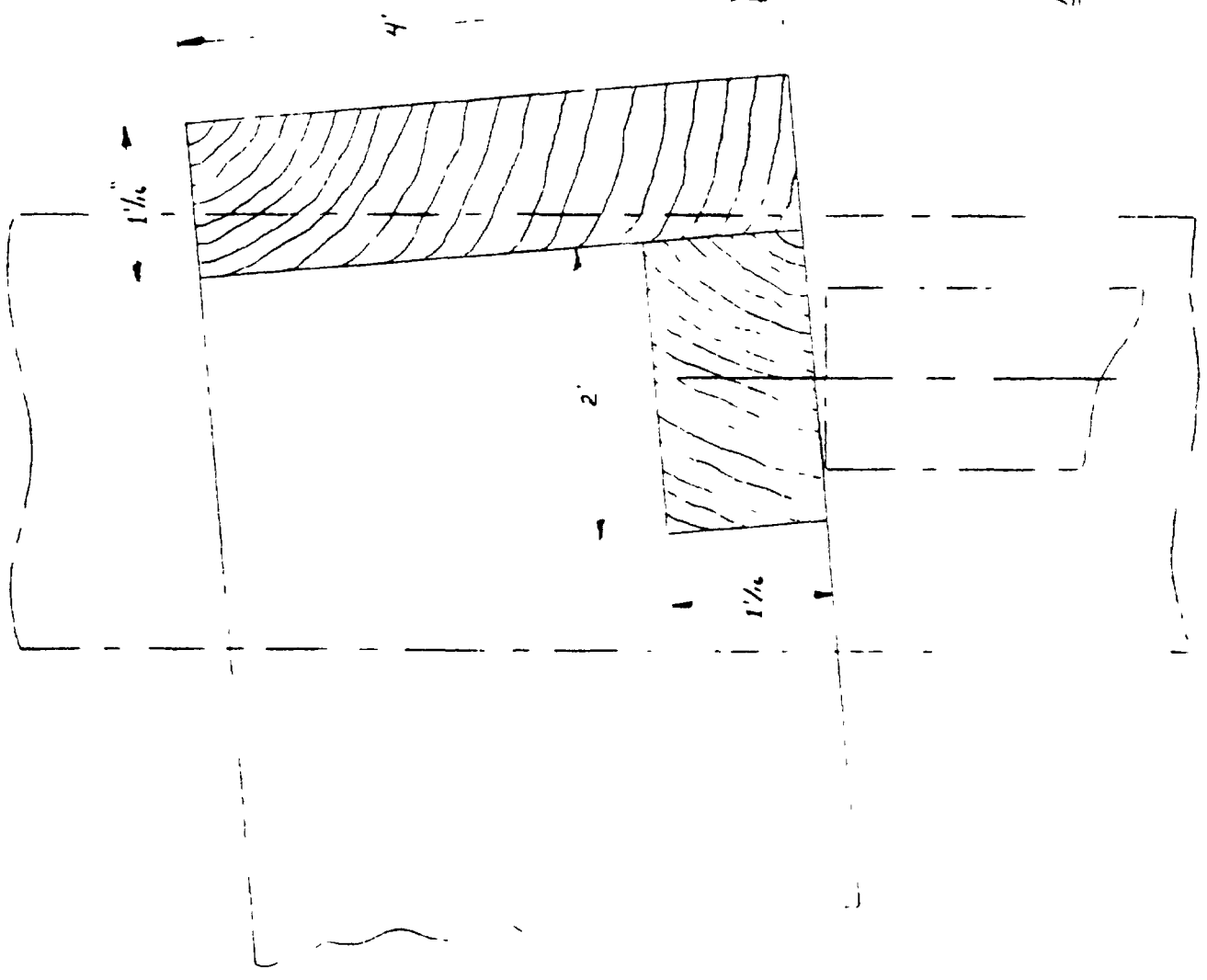


Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

NOT TO SCALE

DETAIL C

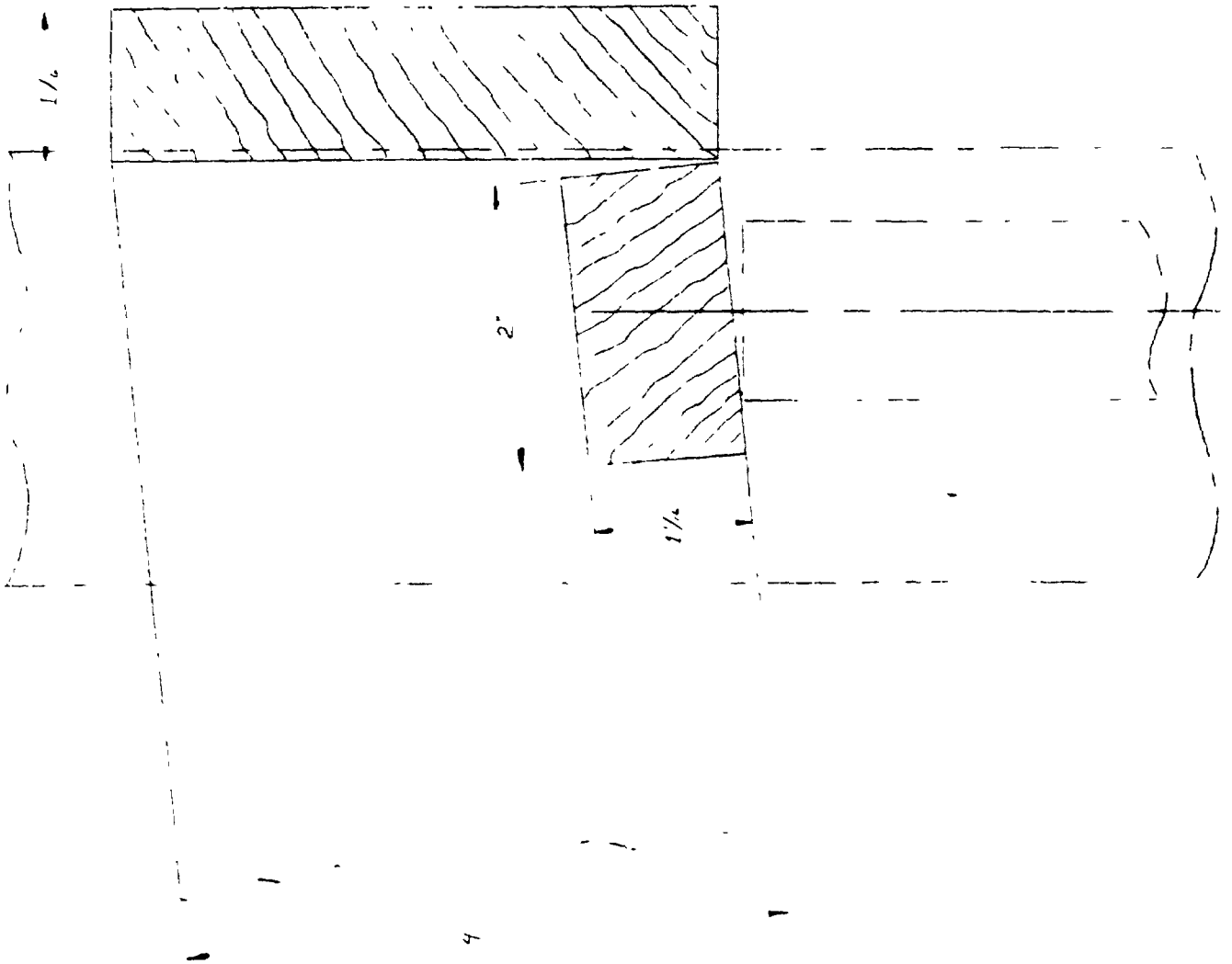
FIGURE 6C



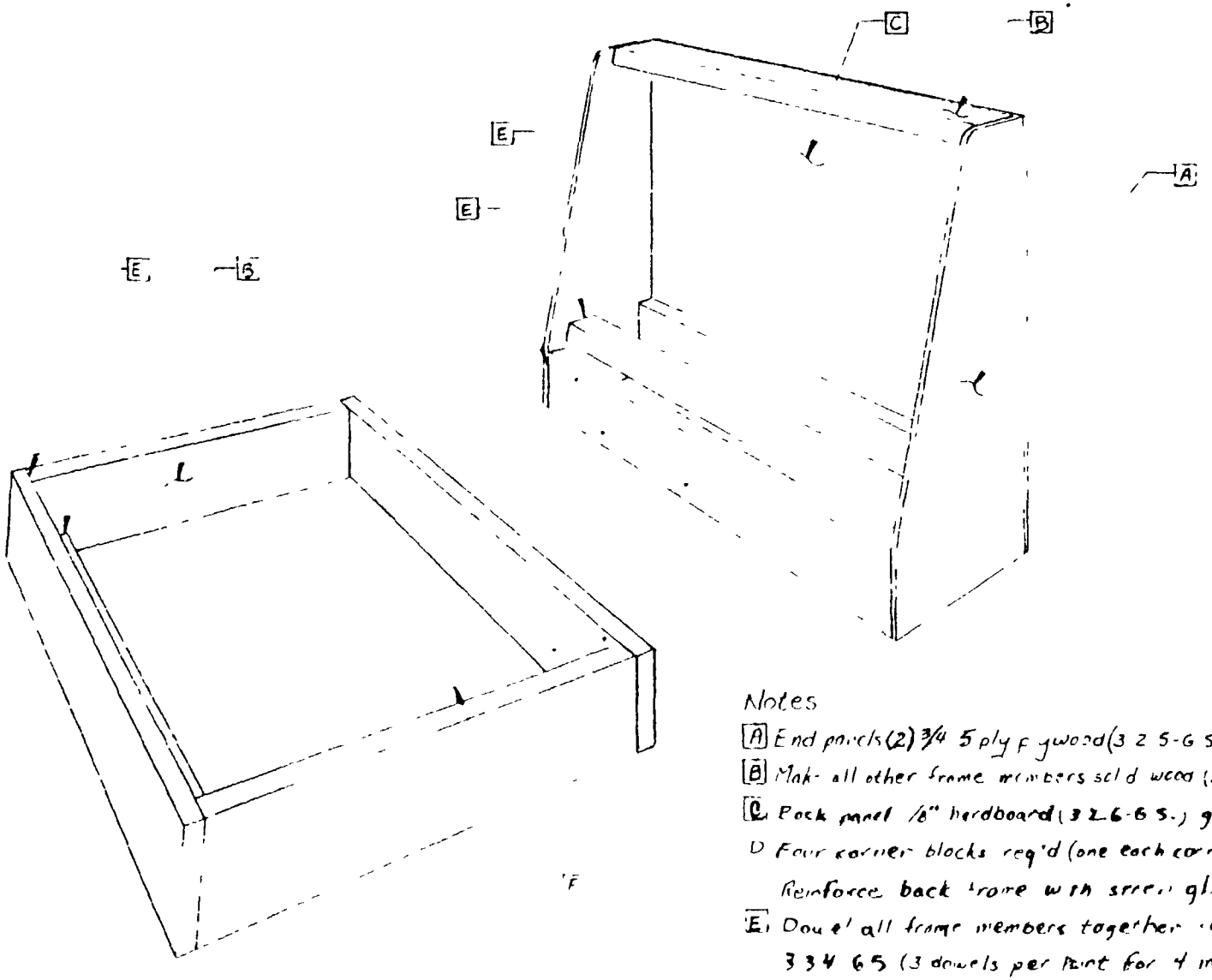
Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

NOT TO SCALE
DETAIL C'

FIGURE 6C'



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-26T11:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



SEAT AND BACK FRAME FOR
TYPE I CHAIR, TYPE II and III SOFAS
FIGURE 7

Notes

A. End panels (2) 3/4 5 ply F gwood (3 2 5-G S) or 1" solid stock (3 2 16-GS.)

B. Mak- all other frame members solid wood (3 2 16 - G S.)

C. Back panel /8" hardboard (3 2 6-G S.) glued and stapled in p ks

D. Four corner blocks req'd (one each corner) for seat frame. Reinforce back frame with screw glue blocks as req'd

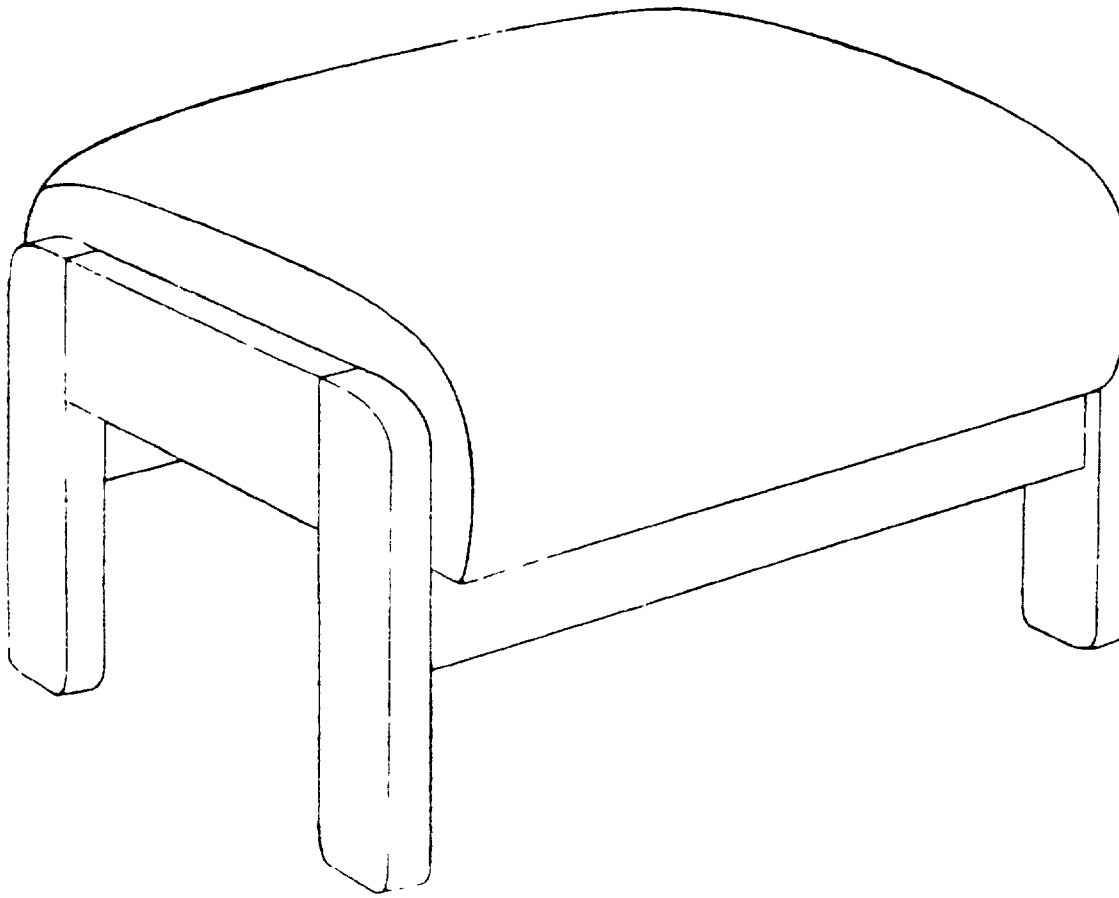
E. Dowel all frame members together see 3 2 8 GS and 3 3 4 G S (3 dowels per joint for 4 inch members and 2 dowels per joint for 2-2 1/4 inch members

F. Bolt seat frame to back frame with a r... ... ... 5/16-18 T nuts bolts and lock ...

G. Seat and back cushion construction described in par 3.8 1 and 3 8 2

AA-F-001873/1A(GSA-FSS)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



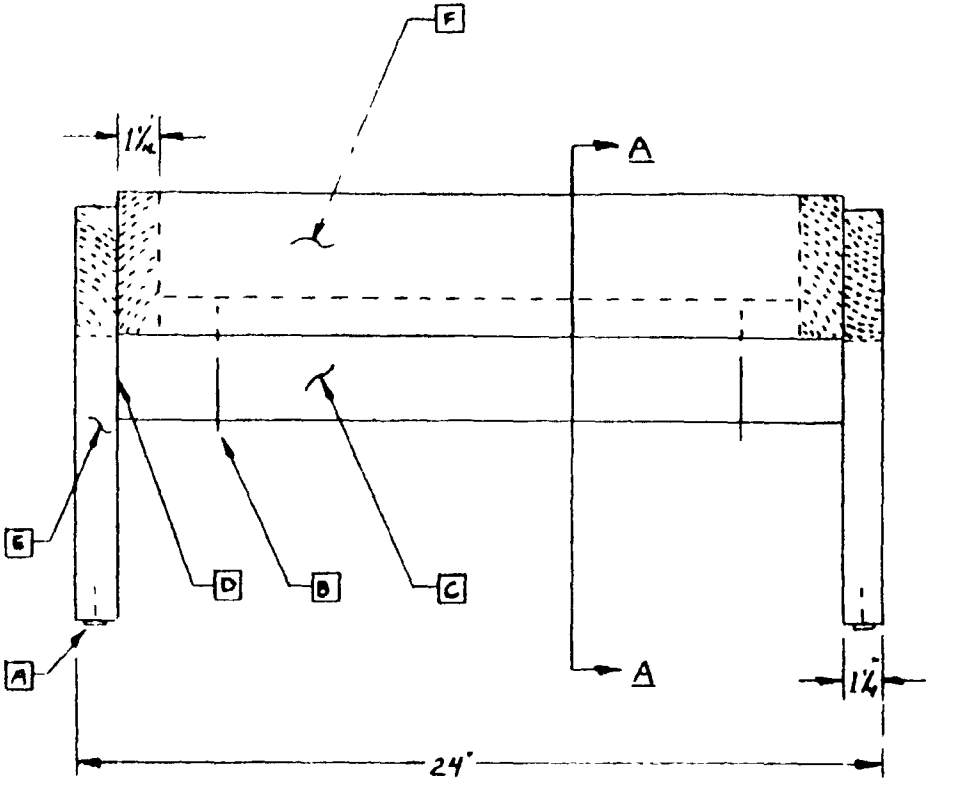
OTTOMAN
TYPE IV
24"W x 20"D x 15⅛ H

FIGURE 8

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

NOTES:

[A] Glides 3 2.14-6.3. - 4 req'd
[B] Seat frame attached to front and rear support rails with a minimum of 2 counter-bored screws per rail.
[C] Support rails, exposed Make from solid wood (3 2.16-6.3) typ. 2 pcs. front and rear.
[D] Make joints as specified in 3 3.4-6.5
[E] Exterior side frames, typ 2 pcs ref
[F] Interior seat frame - ref



FRONT VIEW

TYPE IV OTTOMAN
With cushion frame

NOT TO SCALE

FIGURE 9

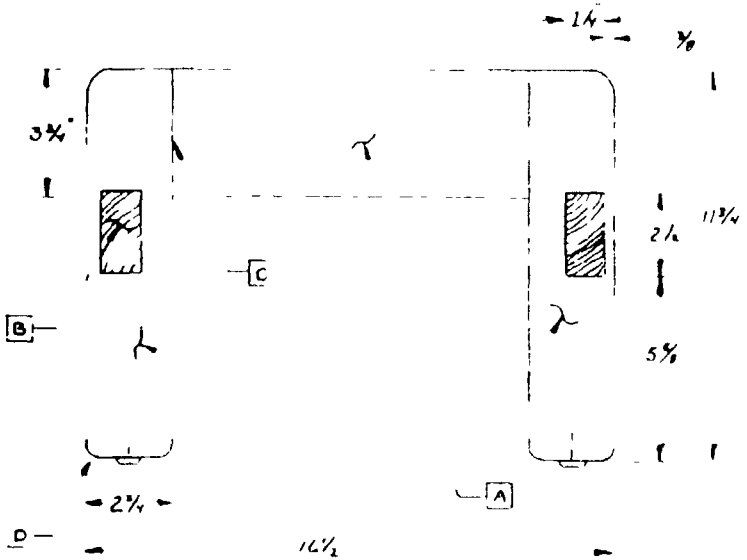
Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 20260-26T11:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

NOTES

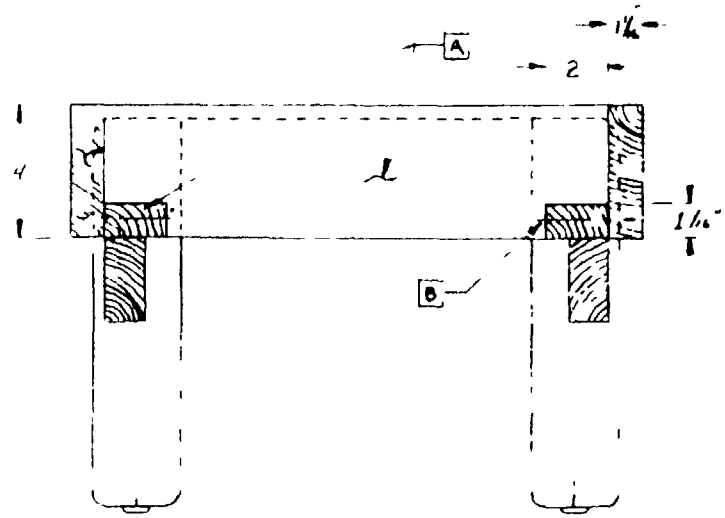
A Exact or side frames (typ 2 pcs) Make from solid wood (32 16 GS)
B Support rails ref
C Make side frame joints flush both sides typ 8 pls
D ½ radius typ 8 pls
E 1 radius typ 4 pls

NOTOES

A Interior seat frame unexposed make all members solid wood Dowel all frame members (except screw rails) together with 3 dowels per joint see 32 B GS and 13 H GS
B Attach screw rail to seat frame with 7 evenly spaced screws
C Seat cushion construction described in paragraph



OTTOMAN
Cushion removed



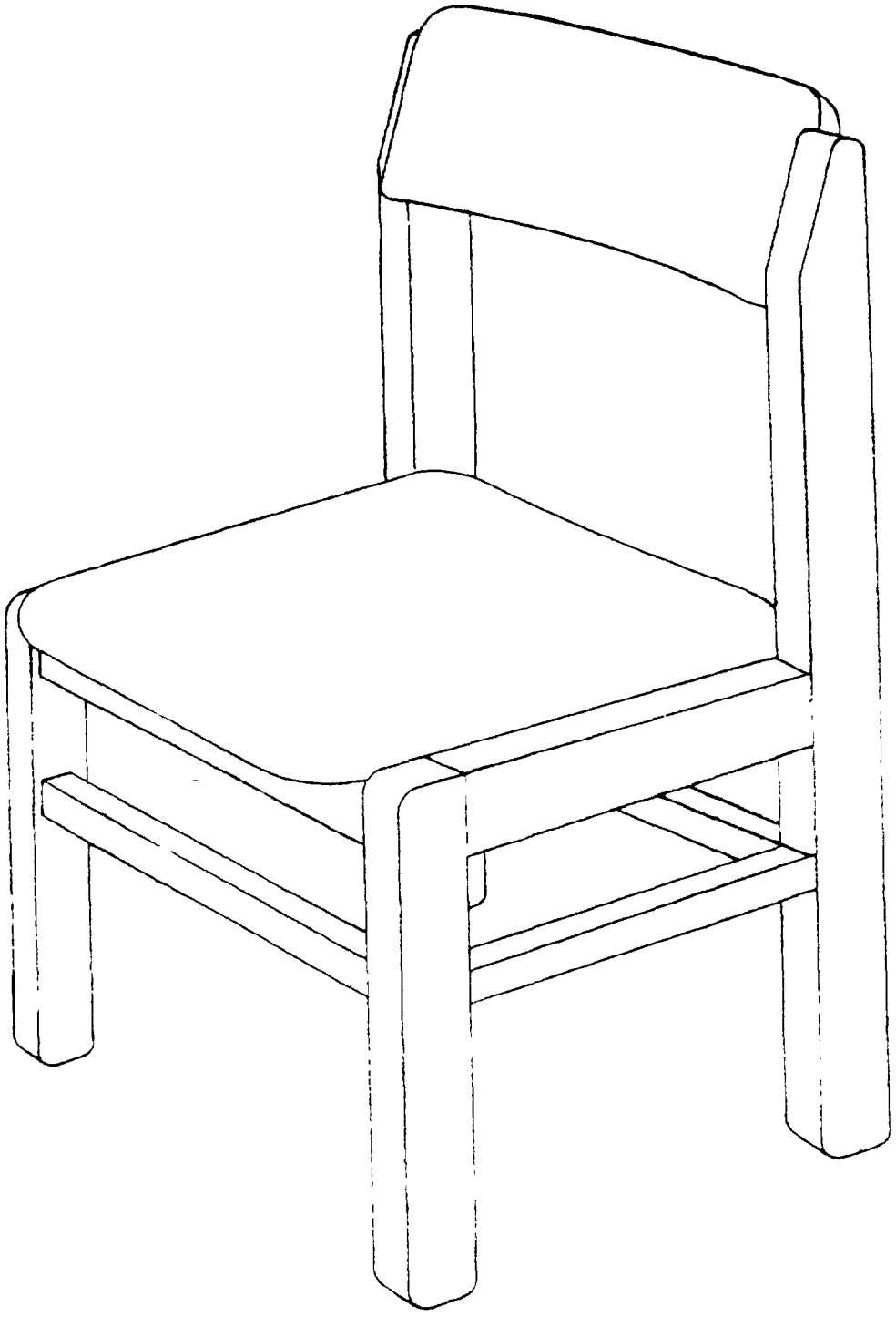
OTTOMAN
With cushion frame

FIGURE 10

NOT TO SCALE

AA-F-001873/1A(GSA-FSS)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



TYPE II SIDE CHAIR
20½"WIDE x 21" DEEP x 32" HIGH

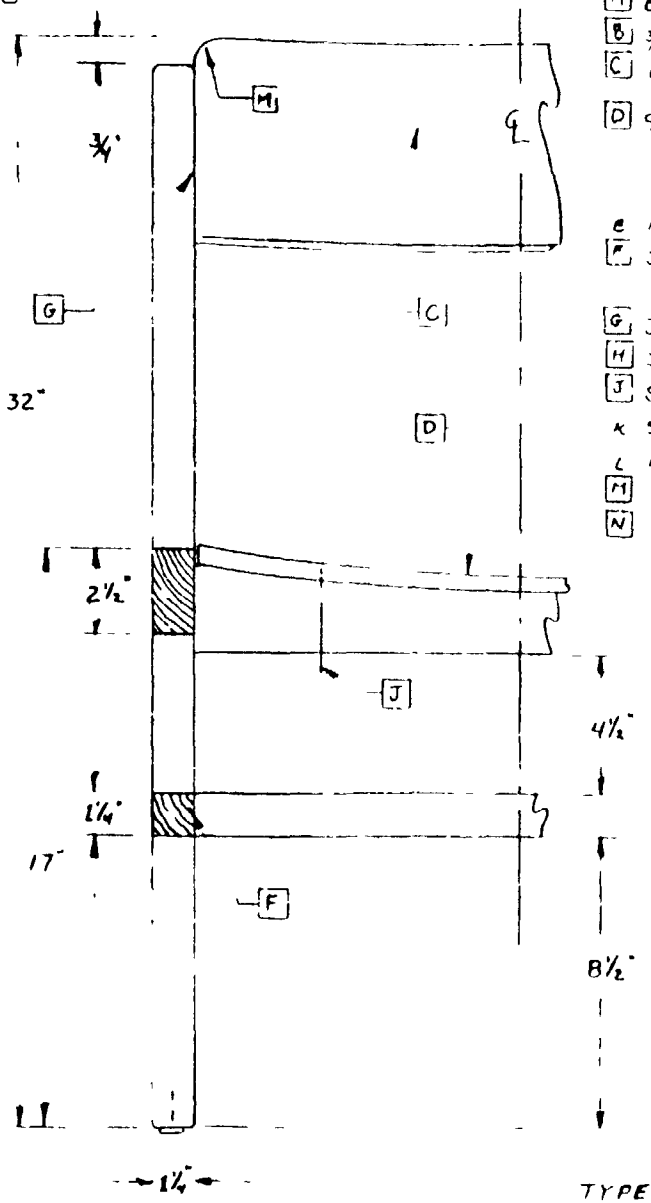
NOT TO SCALE

FIGURE 11

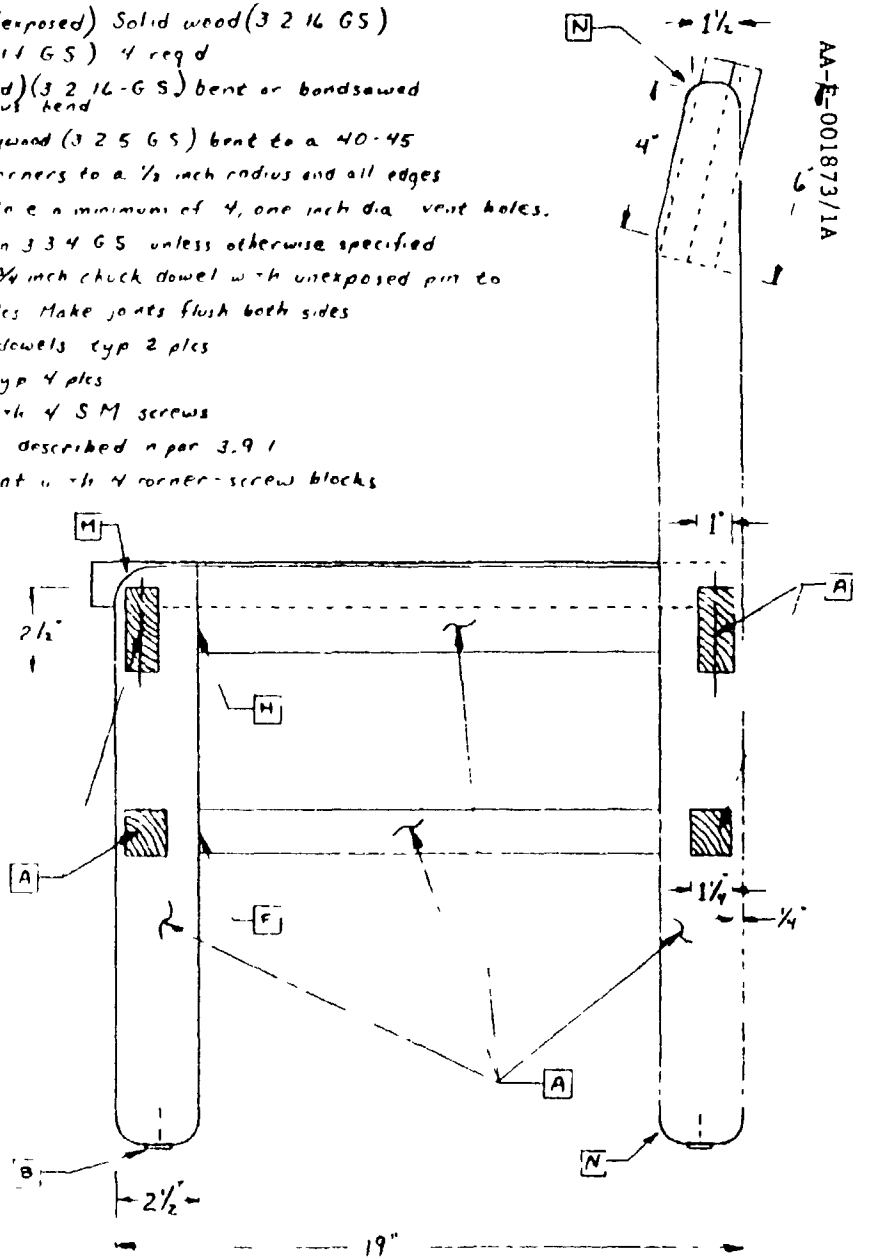
Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

NOTES

A Exterior frame members (exposed) Solid wood (3 2 16 GS)
B 3/4" diameter glides (3 2 11 GS) 4 req'd
C Back solid wood (exposed) (3 2 16-GS) bent or bandsawed to a 40-45 inch radius bend
D Seat pan 1/8 inch 4 ply plywood (3 2 5 GS) bent to a 40-45 inch radius Round all corners to a 1/8 inch radius and all edges to a 1/2 inch radius Bore a minimum of 4, one inch dia vent holes.
E Make joints as specified in 3 3 4 GS unless otherwise specified
F Joints 5/8 inch diameter x 3/4 inch chuck dowel with unexposed pin to prevent twist typ 8 plcs Make joints flush both sides
G Joint, 3 1/8 inch diameter dowels typ 2 plcs
H Joints flush both sides typ 4 plcs
J Seat secured to frame with 4 SM screws
K Seat cushion construction described in par 3.9.1
L Reinforce frame under seat with 4 corner-screw blocks
M 1 inch radius typ 4 plcs
N 1/2 inch radius typ 12 plcs



NOT TO SCALE



NOT TO SCALE

TYPE V SIDE CHAIR

FIGURE 12

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 20260-26T11:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.